

methods. A crime that is committed or facilitated by the internet falls under the definition of cybercrime. It can be anything from spam mails to fraud attempts. Cybercrime can also mean the unauthorized access to government or corporate secrets through criminal methods. Interestingly, cybercrime also includes illegal music downloads.

Non-money activity on the internet also accounts for cybercrime. For instance, creating viruses on other computers or posting confidential business information on the World Wide Web. There are many categories since the internet is vast. A complete knowledge of the different types of internet fraud would actually help circumvent the danger.

The key to staying safe on the internet is by understanding the fact that protection of personal and private data is absolutely important. And, in our world of Facebook and Twitter, this could be a tough task. Any internet related activity is vulnerable to crime and can lead to victimization, which can be traumatic. Sadly, the tools used are a lot more complicated resulting in a plethora of crimes on the internet, not really good news for the end users. The complexity arises due to the ability of the internet to provide anonymity to the criminals and offering them a range of victims who can easily be conned. So, in perspective, it is the responsibility of the individual to protect not just themselves but also their families from internet crimes. This can be done by ensuring safe online practices which will be highlighted in detail in the following pages.

Parental guidance

A lot of cybercrimes revolve around unsuspecting teenagers and school children. Parents play a vital role in ensuring that their children are safe on the internet and not vulnerable to hackers and identity theft. To start with, treat confidential information as confidential. Never reveal such sensitive data on the internet. Begin by telling your children that giving out personal information like address or telephone number or Facebook password to friends, on or off the internet. Ensure that your children don't do that as vital information should be kept secret.

It is always better to have a strong firewall installed in your computer, especially armed with parental controls. You can choose from commercial online services which offer amazing features, letting you and your child be safe.

Teenagers have a complicated life and an internet prowler sure is not going to make it any easier. Ensure that your children don't agree to meet